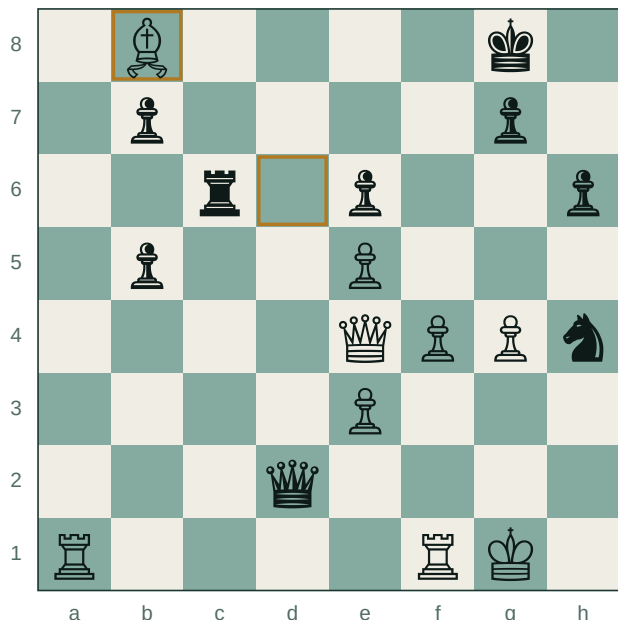


Quiet tactical moves: Black, move 31

Quiet tactical moves

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Bxb8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Rc2 32. Qxc2 Qxc2

31...Rc2 The rook moves from c6 to c2. Recorded reply: **32.Qxc2**.

32...Qxc2 The queen captures the queen on c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -4 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b8 and queen on e4. Check for tactical protection.